

Abraham admonishes his sons and his sons' sons to work righteousness, observe circumcision, and refrain from impurity and idolatry, 1-10. Dismisses them with gifts, 11. Dwelling-places of the Ishmaelites and of the sons of Keturah, 12-13. (Cf. Gen. xxv. 5-6.)

2052
(? 2045) A.M.

XX. And in the forty-second jubilee, in the first year of the †seventh† week, Abraham called Ishmael, and his twelve sons, and Isaac and his two sons, and the six sons of Keturah, and their sons. 2. And he commanded them that they should observe the way of the Lord; that they should work righteousness, and love each his neighbour, and act on this manner amongst all men; that they should each so walk with regard to them as to do judgment and righteousness on the earth. 3. That they should circumcise their sons, according to the covenant which He had made with them, and not deviate to the right hand or the left of all the paths which the Lord had commanded us; and that we should keep ourselves from all fornication and uncleanness, [and renounce from amongst us all fornication and uncleanness]. 4. And if any woman or maid commit fornication amongst you, burn her with fire, and let them not commit fornication with her after their eyes and their heart; and let them not take to themselves wives from the daughters of Canaan; for the seed of Canaan will be rooted out of the

XX. 1. †Seventh†. "Seventh" seems corrupt for "sixth." The present text makes the date 2052 or the year after Abraham's death. If we read "sixth" it would give 2045. See note on xxi. 1. Thus some time would intervene between the dismissal of Ishmael and his sons to their distant homes (xx. 11) and the return of Ishmael and Jacob to celebrate the feast of weeks (xxii. 1).

His twelve sons. See Gen. xxv. 13-15.

2. *Men*=sab'ē emended from šab'ē, "war."

3. *Circumcise their sons.* Sanh. 59 b contains a discussion as to whether circumcision was obligatory on Ishmael's and Keturah's sons in conformity with Gen. xvii. 9. Owing to Gen. xxi. 12 it was held not to extend to Esau's descendants.

[*And renounce . . . uncleanness*]. Bracketed as a dittography.

4. This halacha does not agree exactly with those in Leviticus and Deuteronomy, etc., but with that implied in Gen. xxxviii. 24. According to Deut. xxii. 23 sqq.; Ezek. xvi. 40; Lev. xx. 10 the adulteress was to be put to